

Northwind Logistics — Employee Handbook
Section 2: Leave, Pay and Expenses

Annual leave. Full-time employees receive 27 days of paid annual leave per calendar year, in addition to public holidays in their country of residence. Leave accrues monthly and up to five unused days may be carried into the following year. Carried days expire on 31 March.

Requesting leave. Submit leave requests through the People Operations portal at least two weeks in advance for absences of a week or less, and at least six weeks in advance for anything longer. Managers are expected to respond within three working days. Requests are rarely refused, but during the pre-Christmas freight peak the dispatch team limits simultaneous absences to two people.

Sick leave. There is no fixed cap on paid sick leave. Tell your manager as early in the day as you can. A doctor's note is required only for absences longer than seven consecutive calendar days. Time off for medical appointments is not counted as sick leave.

Parental leave. Northwind offers 26 weeks of fully paid parental leave to any parent, regardless of gender or whether the child joined the family by birth, adoption or surrogacy. Leave may be taken in up to three separate blocks within the first two years.

Expenses. Reasonable work expenses are reimbursed within one payroll cycle. Submit receipts through the expenses tool within 60 days of the spend. Travel booked more than three weeks ahead does not need pre-approval below £500; anything above that, or booked at shorter notice, needs a manager's sign-off. Client entertainment is capped at £60 per head.

Pay reviews. Salaries are reviewed once a year in April, with a mid-year adjustment in October for anyone whose role has materially changed. Northwind does not award discretionary individual bonuses; instead a company-wide profit share is paid each February if operating margin exceeds 6 percent.